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# The Agentic Engineer

How AI is reshaping what it means to build software.

# A quick orientation.

- Forward Deployed AI Engineer at [Tribe AI](#).
- Previously: multi-agent platform at TIFIN; GenAI infrastructure at Johnson & Johnson.
- Author, [Unlocking Data with Generative AI and RAG](#) — Packt, 2 editions, top-10 Amazon AI.
- MADS '22 · MBA, Babson · 15+ years shipping production AI/ML.

I shipped a multi-agent platform last year.  
I typed about 5% of the code.

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TIFIN: 15+ fintech companies, one agentic platform sitting above all of them.

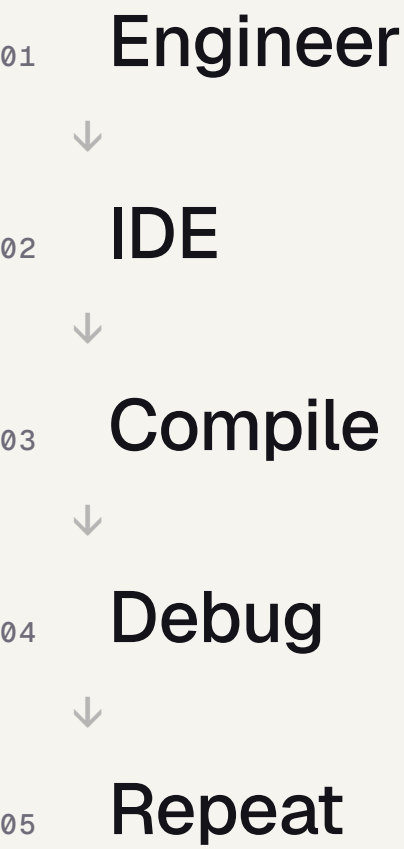
Built for **agentic Kaizen** — continuous improvement across eng, HR, finance, support.

Cleared months of bug backlog across 15 companies in under a week.

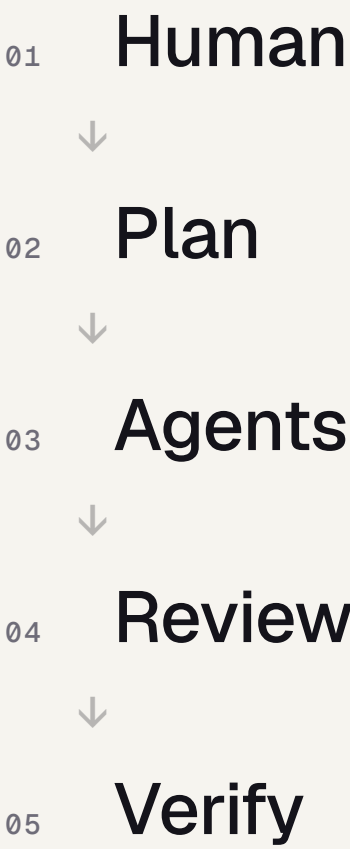
I architected it. Agents built it.

# The loop has changed.

THEN



NOW



From authoring code → to authoring intent and verification.

# Agentic engineering, defined.

- **Specifications, not snippets.**  
You write specs dense enough that agents can execute them.
- **Judgment is the human's job.**  
You stay in the loop for system design, verification, and taste.
- **Systems, not lines of code.**  
You design how the parts fit, not how each line reads.
- **The PRD is the primary artifact.**  
Product requirements as executable input — not a doc someone reads after.



# How a feature gets built, today.



01

Open-ended thinking



02

Initial plan



03

PRD

with audit + test scope baked in



04

Prompt suite



05

Claude Code (CLI)

executes



06

Audit agent

full test suite + auto-fix on findings



07

Final manual review

I use LLMs at every step from 1 → 6.    Production work runs 3-20 CLIs in parallel.

# What this actually looks like.

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**Cowork (left)** orchestrates from a PRD I built in ~1 hour beforehand — generating prompts I paste into **Claude Code (right)**. Includes the audit prompts.

“You still need a strong technical background. I knew the data schema I needed — when I saw the agent had altered it mid-build, in a way that would have broken downstream, I stopped the show. You can't vibe-code your way out of that.”

# Where human judgment still wins.

- Ambiguous problems agents will confidently get wrong.
- System design across boundaries agents can't see.
- Knowing when to stop — when a solution is wrong enough to scrap.
- Designing **evaluations** — what does “good” even mean here?
- Taste. The thing you can't write down.



# The skills shift — and why data scientists are unusually well-positioned.

## DEPRECIATING

- Syntax fluency
- Boilerplate
- Glue code
- Memorized APIs
- Framework trivia

## APPRECIATING

- Model literacy
- NLP fundamentals
- Statistical intuition
- System design
- **Evaluation**

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“Every leader says eval matters. It's the first thing cut when the team is behind.  
**Agentic engineering doesn't let you cut it.”**

# MADS didn't teach you to compete with agents. It taught you the skills agents depend on.

- Understanding what's under the model — not just calling APIs.
- NLP foundations — retrieval, embeddings, tokenization, why they behave that way.
- Eval design — measure it or it didn't happen.
- Statistical intuition — knowing when a result is real.
- Problem decomposition — the precondition for writing PRDs agents can execute.

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The technical foundations matter — but the deeper value is that **MADS taught you to think and work like a data scientist**. It's why my code ships cleaner. Why my decisions are data-driven. Why I frame problems differently than engineering-only colleagues. The way of thinking is what compounds — and it's the thing agents can't replicate.

# I don't know where this is going. I'm running an experiment to find out.

- Memriq.ai — my thought experiment. What if you pushed to the limit and built a company with only agents? Not a prediction. A way to learn what's possible.
- **My actual belief: push humans up the value equation.** Less typing, less repetition. More judgment, taste, design, framing.
- **The point isn't replacement.** It's about humans operating at the top of their stack.



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PODCAST [Agentification of enterprises = Kaizen for the AI era.](#)

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# If you're in MADS right now, here's the playbook.

01 Get good at writing PRDs — plans dense enough agents can execute them.

03 Use agents end-to-end on something real before you graduate.

02 Build serious eval muscle. Make it your edge.

04 Stay opinionated about what humans are actually for.

→ GET INVOLVED Recruiting invite cohorts for companies launching out of Memriq. Request early access at [topsway.ai](https://topsway.ai).

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- EMAIL [bourne@umich.edu](mailto:bourne@umich.edu)